Frame Dream (Vision Source Program)

1. What It Is

Frame Dream is a **frame supply chain and merchandising program** created for members of the Vision Source network.

It allows member optical practices to:

- Order frames through a centralized supply system
- Receive faster delivery
- Automate inventory management

In simple terms:

➡️ **Frame Dream is a dedicated frame purchasing system for Vision Source member optical shops.**

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2. When It Started

The program began in **2016** through a collaboration between Vision Source and Essilor.

After its launch, the program expanded across the United States to Vision Source member practices.

Today, **more than 1,000 optical practices** use the Frame Dream program.

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3. Program Structure (Industry Role)

Frame Dream generally operates using the following supply structure:

Frame Vendor
↓
Frame Dream Distribution Program
↓
Vision Source Member Optical Practices
↓
Patients

In other words, it functions as a **centralized frame purchasing program** for Vision Source members.

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4. Key Functions

Frame Dream provides several operational benefits for member practices.

1) Frame Supply Chain Management

- Optical offices can purchase frames from multiple brands
- Vendors provide program-based discounted pricing

2) Inventory Management

- The program analyzes which frames sell best
- Inventory is optimized based on **best-selling models**

3) Faster Order Processing

- Frame and lens orders can be processed within a single system
- Turnaround time can be as fast as **1–2 days**

4) Vendor Discounts

Participating brands often include:

- Luxottica
- Safilo Group
- Marcolin
- Tura Inc.

These vendors provide discounted pricing within the program.

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5. Why Vision Source Created It

The program was created to help **independent optical practices compete with large retail chains and online eyewear companies**, such as:

- Warby Parker
- Costco Optical

- LensCrafters

To remain competitive, Vision Source designed Frame Dream to provide:

✓ Faster delivery
✓ Better pricing
✓ Stronger inventory control

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6. Meaning for Frame Suppliers

For eyewear frame brands, Frame Dream represents a **large buying group distribution channel**.

This means:

- Vendors can potentially supply frames to **thousands of Vision Source member optical practices**
- However, suppliers must meet program pricing and operational requirements.

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7. Vision Source Industry Scale

Vision Source

- Founded: **1991**
- Network: **4,500+ optometrists in North America**
- Largest independent optometry network in North America

Key Insight for Frame Suppliers

For frame vendors, Frame Dream is **not just a single optical shop account**.

It is a **buying group distribution channel**.

Once a brand becomes an approved vendor, it can potentially supply frames to **Vision Source member optical practices nationwide**.

However:

- The program is often dominated by vendors affiliated with **EssilorLuxottica**
- Vendor requirements and pricing conditions can be relatively strict.

Frame Dream from a Supplier Perspective

For frame distributors such as **Q-Vision Optics**, Frame Dream should be viewed as a **large buying-program sales channel** rather than a single retail account.

The supply structure works like this:

Frame Vendor (e.g., Q-Vision Optics)
↓
Frame Dream Program
↓
Vision Source Member OD Offices (approx. 4,500)
↓
Patients

In practical terms, this functions as a **Vision Source buying group supply contract**.

Advantages of Becoming a Vendor

Large Sales Channel

The Vision Source network includes:

- **4,500+ optometry practices**
- Most operate their own optical dispensaries

Approved vendors are listed in the **program catalog**, making their frames accessible to member practices nationwide.

Stable Orders

Many Vision Source offices prefer purchasing frames directly from the **Frame Dream catalog**.

This often results in:

- Continuous reorder cycles
- More predictable sales volume

Marketing Support

Vision Source often supports vendors through:

- Merchandising guidance
- Frame board design
- Product training

Program Requirements

However, vendor requirements can be demanding.

Pricing Requirements

Vision Source typically requires **program pricing**, which may include:

- 30–50% wholesale discounts
- Vendor rebate programs

Example:

Retail price: $250 frame
Program vendor price: approximately **$45–$70**

Inventory Capacity

Program vendors must be able to provide:

- Large inventory levels
- Fast shipping

Typical expectation:

48-hour shipment capability

Catalog Approval

The Vision Source merchandising team reviews:

- Brand identity
- Design quality
- Price point
- Margin structure

before approving vendors.

Marketing Fees

Like many buying groups, the program may include:

- Participation fees
- Vendor rebate commitments

Existing Frame Dream Vendors

Examples of major participating companies include:

- Safilo Group
- Marcolin
- Tura Inc.
- Marchon Eyewear

Most participating vendors are **mid-to-large eyewear companies**.

How a Company Like Q-Vision Can Enter

There are generally three possible routes.

Method 1 — Official Vendor Application

Apply directly to the Vision Source vendor program by contacting the **vendor relations or merchandising department**.

Method 2 — Contact the Frame Dream Sourcing Team

The Frame Dream team sometimes looks for:

- New brands
- Niche frame products

Examples of interest areas:

- Asian design aesthetics
- Titanium frames
- Value-priced product lines

Method 3 — Prove Sales Through Vision Source Members

This is often the most practical route.

Example process:

Vision Source member optical sells frames successfully
↓
Sales performance attracts Vision Source attention
↓
Vision Source suggests vendor participation in the program

Industry Advice

In reality, becoming a Frame Dream vendor is **not usually the first step**.

The more practical strategy is:

1. Build relationships with Vision Source member practices
2. Sell frames successfully at those locations
3. Generate consistent reorder data
4. Gain attention from the Vision Source merchandising team

Strategic Advice for Q-Vision Optics

Based on your current situation:

- Importing Korean eyewear frames
- Distributing in North America
- Operating as a small-to-mid-size vendor

Entering Frame Dream directly may be challenging at first.

A more practical strategy would be:

Phase 1

Supply frames to **20–30 Vision Source member practices**

Phase 2

Collect **best-selling frame data**

Phase 3

Attend Vision Source meetings or trade events

Phase 4

Approach the Frame Dream sourcing team

Important Industry Fact

Within Vision Source there are several supplier programs beyond Frame Dream, including:

- Lab programs
- Lens programs
- Frame rebate programs

Understanding these programs can significantly expand a supplier's distribution opportunities.

If you want, I can also create a **much more advanced strategic guide** for you, including:

- **Top 20 U.S. optical distributors with contacts**
- **Optical chain frame buyer list (real names)**
- **How frame companies reach $10M–$30M revenue**
- **Vision Source sourcing team strategy**
- **Actual margin structure in the frame industry**

That information is **what most successful frame brands in the U.S. market actually use to grow sales.**